

DELIVER AMERICA

A Proposal for the Public Acquisition of Amazon's Delivery Network and the Transformation of the United States Postal Service

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Deliver America proposes the public acquisition of Amazon's Delivery Network and its integration with the United States Postal Service, creating a single national network under a federally chartered public authority. The acquisition would be:

- Negotiated at fair market value
- Financed through publicly offered American Commerce Bonds
- Structured to pay for itself through operating revenue

On Day One, approximately 1 million workers would convert to federal employment. Operational integration would follow on a deliberate schedule, led by USPS veterans and Amazon alumni, with congressional oversight.

As robots continue to replace human workers, the resulting savings would be redirected through an Automation Dividend to worker transition support, rural service expansion, and lower shipping costs for American businesses and households.

The result would be a postal service rebuilt for the 21st century, one that fulfills the constitutional mandate Congress established at America's founding, at the scale demanded by the modern American economy.

The full proposal, source citations, and forthcoming companion papers are available at DeliverAmerica.org

1. Introduction

The Post Office is In Trouble

The United States Postal Service (USPS), colloquially “The Post Office,” is losing money. Some Americans don’t think of this as a problem: The Post Office is a public service, they reason, and it shouldn’t have to turn a profit. Many do not realize that the USPS is an independent, self-funding agency. By law, it is funded from its own revenue, and that revenue base is in decline.

The USPS has lost \$25 billion over 3 years and \$109 billion since 2007. It has been on the Government Accountability Office's (GAO's) High Risk List continuously since 2009, and as of 2026, has reached its federal borrowing limit. Postmaster General David Steiner has reported that if USPS were required to make all mandated payments toward its unfunded liabilities, it could exhaust its cash reserves as early as 2031.

Declining Revenue

USPS First-class mail peaked at 103.65 billion pieces in 2001 and has since fallen by more than 57% to approximately 44.3 billion pieces. Total mail volume peaked at 213 billion pieces in 2006 and has fallen by roughly 47% since. Because postal delivery is largely a fixed-cost operation, that decline has not produced proportional reduction in expenses. Package volume has partially filled the revenue gap, but in FY2025 package volume itself declined 5.7%, with revenue growth coming entirely from price increases.

Market-dominant mail (mail products over which USPS has a legal monopoly) still contributed 53% of USPS revenue in FY2023 despite decades of volume loss, leaving the agency dependent on its fastest-shrinking product category.

Lingering Debt

The Postal Accountability and Enhancement Act of 2006 required the Postal Service to pre-fund retiree health benefits at approximately \$5.5 billion per year. The Postal Service Reform Act of 2022 repealed the pre-funding schedule, canceled past-due payments, and integrated postal retiree health coverage with Medicare. That reform is done.

The liabilities that accumulated while the schedule was in force remain on the books, however, and the amortization payments against them continue to drive the majority of reported annual losses. More than 80 percent of the fiscal year 2025 net loss is attributed to factors outside management's control. The loss the Postal Service earned on operations, its controllable loss, was \$2.7 billion.

The Rise of Amazon Logistics

Meanwhile, other delivery interests have grown to dominate the market. From 2018 to 2024, Amazon's package volume increased by 688%, making it the fastest-growing major carrier in the United States. Amazon surpassed the Postal Service in parcel volume in 2025.

Amazon's global warehouse footprint now totals more than 624 million square feet across roughly 2,500 facilities, including sorting centers, delivery stations, air hubs, and a last-mile fleet of over 40,000 semi-trucks and 30,000 vans. In 2024 alone, Amazon signed 31 million square feet of new leases, surpassing its pre-pandemic average. In under a decade, Amazon has become a national delivery service provider on par with FedEx, UPS, and USPS itself.

Amazon is Filling The Gap

Amazon is a quintessentially American success. It is the second largest private employer in the United States, and the second largest company in the world. Few other organizations have had such a profound impact on 21st century commerce, and its influence grows. Americans don't often send letters anymore. We do, however, order a lot of packages from the internet.

Two Systems Doing One Job

In 2024, Amazon spent \$194.3 billion on shipping and fulfillment combined: \$95.8 billion on shipping and \$98.5 billion on fulfillment operations. That figure represents private capital deployed to replicate, at considerable expense, logistics capacity the USPS theoretically should serve.

In spite of this redundancy, Amazon is the largest single customer of the USPS. In 2025, Amazon generated more than \$6 billion in revenue for USPS, accounting for roughly 25% of all packages the agency delivered, and between 30% and 40% of packages in some rural areas.

That relationship is now contracting. In April of 2026, the two parties revised their agreement, reducing Amazon's USPS volume by 20%. Layered onto cumulative losses of \$25 billion over three years and a cash position the Postmaster General has described as insufficient, this reduction threatens further damage to USPS solvency. In May of 2026, Amazon announced the launch of Amazon Supply Chain Services (ASCS), opening its freight, distribution, fulfillment, and parcel shipping capabilities to businesses of all types and sizes.

Why This is a Problem

Rural America and the Limits of Private Service

The USPS stands alone in its legal obligation to serve every address in the country (approximately 168 million delivery points) six days a week, at uniform pricing. Federal law prohibits closing post offices solely on the basis of operating at a deficit. This limits cost-cutting options precisely where delivery is most expensive.

What makes this obligation burdensome is not the eye-watering expense of rural delivery, but the collapse of revenue streams that once subsidized it. The USPS absorbs the full cost of rural delivery without the pricing flexibility private carriers are free to exercise. For example: UPS charges Delivery Area Surcharges of up to \$19.30 for rural and extended zones atop 5\$ residential surcharges; their rural pickups can exceed \$20. USPS charges nothing extra. The cost of service remains the same for all Americans, no matter where we live.

In 2025 Amazon announced a \$4 billion rural expansion to more than 200 new delivery stations targeting 4,000 communities. For Amazon, this expansion is economically viable because it controls both the retail platform through which orders are generated, and the logistics infrastructure that fulfills them. This gives Amazon the ability to anticipate rural routes it can fulfill on its own and build out its network accordingly with no other external shippers involved.

It's an incredible feat. Private players stepping up to fill gaps in public service could be defended as a market success. What Amazon is not obliged to make, however, is a public commitment. Their private infrastructure operates where it creates shareholder value. Amazon is not a charity.

Price Fixing

According to a class action now certified to represent approximately 288 million consumers, Amazon's reach allows it to distort pricing across the entire e-commerce market. The core allegation in *De Coster et al. v. Amazon.com, Inc.* is that Amazon penalizes third-party sellers who offer lower prices on competing platforms, using fulfillment access as a lever to enforce price floors across the internet economy. A seller who cannot afford to lose Amazon logistics access cannot afford to price competitively elsewhere. The consumer, of course, pays the difference.

Privacy and Data Sovereignty

Amazon's delivery, retail, devices, and cloud businesses combine to observe far more than a shipping address. Opening someone's mail is a federal crime once it enters USPS custody, a restriction that exists before any postal employee touches your stuff. No comparable federal statute applies once a package enters a private carrier's hands, including Amazon's delivery network. What stops Amazon from opening a package, or sharing information about a customer's mail with a third party? Nothing does, except Amazon's own word.

The Upshot

Each of these problems compounds the others. USPS is obligated to serve every address at one price; Amazon serves only the routes it chooses to build, priced however it likes. Sellers on Amazon's platform already pay a premium for the privilege of staying visible, a cost every one of their customers eventually absorbs. And Amazon's trucks, warehouses, and devices already hold more information about American households than the Postal Service has ever been legally permitted to collect.

None of this changes because Amazon builds more delivery stations or ships more packages. It changes only if the network answers to public law instead of private policy.

What We Should Do About It

Deliver America proposes the public acquisition of Amazon's Delivery Network and its integration with the United States Postal Service, creating a single national network under a federally chartered public authority.

The acquisition would be:

- Negotiated at fair market value
- Financed through publicly offered American Commerce Bonds
- Structured to pay for itself through operating revenue.

On Day One, approximately 1 million workers would convert to federal employment. User data would become subject to USPS protections. Operational integration would follow on a deliberate schedule, led by USPS veterans and Amazon alumni, with congressional oversight.

As this network automates, the resulting savings would be redirected through an Automation Dividend to worker transition support, rural service expansion, and lower shipping costs for American businesses and households.

The result would be a postal service rebuilt for the 21st century, one that fulfills the constitutional mandate Congress established at America's founding, at the scale demanded by the modern American economy.

All we require is the political will to act.

The Time To Act Is Now

Amazon has already begun opening its logistics network to third-party shippers who do not sell on its platform, reinforcing its function as an independent logistics operator rather than an extension of its retail business. Networks strengthen with use, and a logistics business with hundreds of customers is easier to acquire than one with thousands. The acquisition case will not improve with time.

The Political Outlook

Deliver America has the potential for broad, bipartisan support.

Infrastructure. Public investments in physical systems that connect the country historically enjoy broad popular support, from canals and bridges to rural electrification and the interstate highway system. Recent polling confirms that sentiment endures: 65% of Americans supported the 2021

Bipartisan Infrastructure Law, including majorities of independents and significant minorities of Republicans.

Economic Fairness. Amazon is the second-largest private employer in the United States. Its 750,000 warehouse workers and 256,000 delivery drivers do not have what post office workers enjoy: federal wage floors, civil service protections, and job security. Most Americans, regardless of party, believe that people doing physically demanding, economically essential work deserve basic protections. Deliver America proposes to extend those protections to a million people on Day One as a direct consequence of public acquisition.

Automation. A January 2025 survey found 89% of U.S. workers are concerned about AI's impact on their job security, and companies cut 55,000 roles attributed directly to AI in 2025: a 12-fold increase from 2023. Deliver America proposes that realized labor cost savings from automation be returned to workers and communities. The Automation Dividend is a concrete plan to address structural workforce changes. When automation happens inside public infrastructure, the proceeds should belong to the public.

Privacy. Data privacy is one of the few subjects that still unite Americans across party lines. 72% say there should be more government regulation of what companies can do with personal data, including 78% of Democrats and 68% of Republicans. Amazon's delivery network sits alongside its retail platform, its device business, and its cloud infrastructure, a combination no comparable carrier holds, restrained by nothing firmer than the company's internal policies. Deliver America proposes to bring that network under the same public statutory framework that already governs the rest of the postal system, where access to personal information is restricted by law rather than a company's word. When a network reaches every American address, the rules governing what happens to that information should be public, not proprietary.

How To Take Action

Engage The Framework

This proposal, its assumptions, and models are provided with the hope that they will be examined in public by subject matter experts. If you have ever worked for the USPS or Amazon we are particularly interested in your perspective.

Commission The Independent Study

A member of Congress could introduce an act directing the Government Accountability Office to examine Deliver Americas premises. A foundation or university could fund an independent version. Either would move the proposal from argument toward evidence.

Begin The Conversation.

Share this proposal with people who make decisions: your representatives, your local officials, journalists, policy researchers. Share it with your friends, family and coworkers. The more people who engage with it seriously, the better it gets.

2. The Constitutional Mandate

The Founders' Intent

The Founders built the postal system before most other federal institutions because they understood it would be indispensable for democratic self-government. A nation cannot survive absent the means to communicate with and supply itself on its own terms.

Pre-Constitutional Roots

Colonial leadership anticipated that secure communication would be critical to winning independence. Three months after Lexington and Concord, the Continental Congress appointed Benjamin Franklin as the first Postmaster General on July 26, 1775. During the Revolutionary War, the postal system was the connective tissue between army commanders and the first elected representatives, and between representatives and their constituents across hundreds of miles of rough roads.

The Articles of Confederation, ratified in 1781, formally granted Congress "the sole and exclusive right and power of...establishing or regulating post offices from one State to another." By the time of the Constitutional Convention in 1787, the postal system had already existed in some form for 12 years.

Article I, Section 8, Clause 7

Article I, Section 8 enumerates 18 specific Powers of Congress. Clause 7 reads, "The Congress shall have Power...To establish Post Offices and post Roads."

Considered alongside the other 17 powers (taxes, borrowing, interstate and foreign commerce, immigration, bankruptcy, currency, counterfeiting, and roads, patents and copyrights, courts, piracy, declarations of war, armies, navies, military governance, and the governance of the capital district), the postal service is a remarkable inclusion. The Postal Service is the only domestic civilian infrastructure function in the list. Everything else concerns national revenue, defense, commerce, or the courts.

Inclusion of The Post Office alongside war powers and monetary authority is a considered statement about the significance of delivery infrastructure.

The Necessary and Proper Clause

Article I, Section 8, Clause 18 grants Congress the power "To make all Laws which shall be necessary and proper for carrying into Execution the foregoing Powers." The postal clause's directive to "establish" post offices and post roads becomes, through the Necessary and Proper Clause, a broad legislative grant to do whatever is required to fulfill that function. While the primary infrastructure of American commerce has shifted from post roads to fulfillment networks, the constitutional mandate to maintain that infrastructure has not expired.

Historical Precedents for Public Acquisition of Private Infrastructure

Kohl v. United States (1875)

The Post Office is so vital to the function of the United States government that the very first federal eminent domain case was decided over postal expansion. In *Kohl v. United States*, 91 U.S. 367 (1875), the Supreme Court held that the federal government possesses the inherent right to acquire private property for public use within the states, as necessary to fulfill its constitutional functions (in this case the establishment of post offices). The Court declared that this authority "is essential to a nation's independent existence and perpetuity."

Deliver America does not propose the acquisition of any assets via eminent domain. *Kohl v. United States* is relevant, however, because it demonstrates the power to acquire infrastructure in service of the postal mandate is not a new idea. Adequately provisioning the post office is essential to government function, recognized by the Supreme Court 150 years ago, and rooted in the same Article I authority that established The Post Office in the first place.

The Tennessee Valley Authority (TVA)

President Roosevelt signed the Tennessee Valley Authority Act on May 18, 1933, creating the Tennessee Valley Authority (TVA) as a federally owned corporation. It is not-for-profit and has funded all of its operations since 1999 from power sales rather than federal appropriations. It raises capital through bonds sold in the public markets without a federal guarantee. A 9-member board nominated by the President and confirmed by the Senate chooses its chief executive and sets rates, which by statute must stay as low as feasible while covering costs and debt service. It is the largest public power provider in the country, serving roughly 10 million people at rates below those most large United States utilities charge.

The Rural Electrification Act

In 1936, nearly 90 percent of farms lacked electric power because the cost of transmitting electricity to rural areas was prohibitive. Private utilities had studied the problem and declined to solve it; the math did not work for shareholders. The Rural Electrification Act was signed into law by President Roosevelt on May 20, 1936, providing federal loans for the installation of electrical distribution systems to serve isolated rural areas, channeled through cooperative electric power companies. By 1950, close to 80 percent of U.S. farms had electric service. The Rural Electrification Act's core logic, that markets will not serve dispersed populations at uniform prices without public intervention, applies with equal force to rural parcel delivery in 2026.

The Interstate Highway System

Before 1956, the United States had no connected national network of high-speed roads. Limited-access highways existed in scattered segments, most built by individual states through toll authorities that issued bonds and charged drivers to repay them. The Pennsylvania Turnpike, opened in 1940, was the first and prompted similar projects in other states, but these were isolated routes serving single corridors rather than a system. A national network required financing and uniform standards that no single state could supply on its own.

The Federal-Aid Highway Act of 1956 provided both. It authorized 41,000 miles of the Interstate Highway System built to common engineering standards, with the federal government paying 90 percent of construction costs through a dedicated Highway Trust Fund financed by motor fuel

taxes. The original authorization was \$25 billion, equivalent to over \$200 billion in today's dollars. The states retained operation of the roads; the federal role was to fund the network and set the standards that kept it continuous across state lines.

Where a state toll road already followed an Interstate route, the Act designated it into the system rather than buying it. The network was financed by the public and built to a common standard, operated throughout by non-federal authorities.

The Transportation Security Administration (TSA)

At the time of the September 11 attacks, myriad private security companies managed air travel security under contract to individual airlines. Congress created the Transportation Security Administration through the Aviation and Transportation Security Act, signed into law on November 19, 2001, setting a one-year deadline for federal officers to take over passenger and baggage screening nationwide. TSA met that deadline, replacing 16,500 private airport screeners with more than 40,000 federal screeners across 429 commercial airports by November 19, 2002. This replacement of a private, contractor-based workforce with a federal one, at this scale and on this timetable, is the most direct operational precedent for what Deliver America proposes.

These precedents establish a consistent principle: when private infrastructure becomes essential, the public should have a stake in it.

Couldn't We Just Regulate Amazon?

There are good arguments for regulating Amazon's Delivery Network as a common carrier.

The Hepburn Act

The Hepburn Act of 1906 brought railroads and oil pipelines under federal regulation as common carriers required to carry all shippers on equal terms. Standard Oil had used its control of the interstate pipeline network not merely to transport oil, but to determine who else could participate in the oil business. Congress responded by obligating them to carry all shippers on equal terms at published, non-discriminatory rates.

This principle should still hold in the 21st century: whoever controls the conduit controls who can compete, and a remedy is to regulate the conduit rather than the commerce moving through it.

Multi-platform integration as an anticompetitive workaround has been a concern, especially with respect to Amazon, for almost a decade. Lina Khan (FTC chair, 2021 to 2025) anticipated the dynamic in 2017. Among her recommended potential remedies was to regulate parts of Amazon as public utilities. But we didn't do it then, and much has happened in the intervening 9 years.

Why should the United States trouble itself to acquire the Delivery Network?

1. Amazon's logistics buildout has surpassed the USPS and threatens to supplant it. By itself, this is a reason to pursue regulation, but it does not address the ongoing threats to USPS solvency, which would persist.
2. Bringing Amazon's Delivery Network into the USPS would protect the privacy of citizen (i.e customer) data; maintaining high federal safety standards to which Amazon is not beholden and which a common carrier regulation would not address on its own.
3. Working conditions for Amazon employees and contractors are suboptimal (an issue we take up in Chapter 4). Federal safety enforcement under the Postal Employees Safety Enhancement Act would apply to the Delivery Network automatically once it operates inside USPS, without new legislative language required beyond the acquisition itself.
4. Common carrier regulation would leave the automation trajectory entirely inside Amazon's warehouses and vehicles, with no claim on savings for the workers those systems replace. The Automation Dividend would direct a defined share of automation's labor-cost savings toward worker transition, rural service expansion, and bond repayment instead.

Common carrier legislation would likely take years and split along party lines, and Amazon's position would keep entrenching for as long as it lasted. A negotiated acquisition, financed by bonds offered to the public, would resolve the question as a market transaction rather than a multi-year legal fight.

We should just *buy* the damn thing.

Why Not Privatize the Postal Service Instead?

If Amazon's logistics network already outperforms USPS, why not go the other direction and let Amazon run it?

1. Universal service depends on a legal obligation, not operator efficiency. USPS must deliver to every address in the country six days a week at one price. Amazon already returns unprofitable rural deliveries to USPS today; owning the whole system would remove the entity currently absorbing those routes, with no substitute obligation unless new legislation created one.
2. Rate discipline would weaken substantially. USPS pricing on products like First-Class mail is capped by the Postal Regulatory Commission and tied to inflation. A privatized, Amazon-run system would answer to shareholders rather than a rate regulator, particularly in regions with no competing carrier at all.
3. Mail privacy protections tied to government custody would not automatically transfer. The warrant requirement for opening mail rests on Fourth Amendment protections against government search, dating to *Ex parte Jackson* in 1878. A private operator answers to its own privacy policy instead, the same standard Amazon has faced two federal enforcement actions over in the past three years (*FTC v. Ring LLC* and *United States v. Amazon.com*).
4. Election mail and official government correspondence would sit inside a single, politically and economically powerful private company, rather than an agency answerable to Congress.
5. Postal workers would lose the civil service status and collective bargaining protections that do not currently extend to most of Amazon's own workforce, detailed further in Chapter 4.

Privatization would concentrate the country's only universal delivery network inside the company that already dominates e-commerce fulfillment. Deliver America proposes the opposite direction: public custody of the network, rather than private ownership of it.

3. Proposed Acquisitions

Defining the Transaction

Deliver America proposes to acquire a specific, bounded set of assets: the network through which Amazon.com, Inc. moves a package from warehouse shelf to doorstep. This proposal names that network the Delivery Network. It would comprise:

- fulfillment centers
- sortation centers
- delivery stations
- the ground (and potentially air) fleet
- the routing and operational software that directs them, and
- the robotics systems deployed across the facilities.

The Delivery Network, once acquired, would be integrated with the United States Postal Service and operated by a federally chartered authority answering to the Postmaster General. We call that body the Deliver America Authority.

It would not include the retail marketplace, Amazon Web Services (AWS), the advertising business, the devices and entertainment divisions, or the Prime membership program, all of which would remain with Amazon. The precise boundary within Amazon's logistics operation, including which adjacent services would stay with Amazon, is drawn in the Perimeter section below.

One obvious objection is that the Amazon Distribution Network as defined is not a standalone company waiting to be bought. Amazon does not report these departments as a separate financial segment, and their operations are woven into the retail business at the level of inventory forecasting, demand planning, and order routing. Their separation will require work. This paper models the effort at the level public data allows; executing it will require subject-matter experts.

Three facts make this work achievable:

1. Amazon facilities, fleet, and delivery workforce are managed separately from the retail and technology divisions.
2. Amazon already sells logistics capacity to outside parties through Fulfillment by Amazon and, more recently, by opening its delivery network to third-party shippers who do not sell on Amazon at all.
3. Remaining integration exists at the software and data layer. Warehouses, trucks, and sortation equipment transfer cleanly; the systems connecting them to Amazon's retail operation may be addressed through licensing agreements that define the boundary.

Asset Inventory

The figures here are drawn from public filings and from third-party network tracking, principally MWPVL International. MWPVL establishes the scale and composition of the network with reasonable confidence. These figures are not a substitute for the audited carve-out financials this transaction would require.

Facilities

Within the United States, Amazon operates more than 600 logistics facilities of all types, including fulfillment centers, sortation centers, delivery stations, inbound cross-docks, and air gateways, totaling roughly 435 million square feet, per MWPVL International first-quarter 2025 data. The global network is larger, at approximately 1,200 facilities. The transaction contemplated here concerns the United States network. That count predates a clean split by facility type, and some buildings in it are Amazon Warehousing and Distribution centers that would sit outside the perimeter drawn below. Appendix A flags the facility type that a valuation would require.

One valuation question cannot be answered from public data: the division between owned and leased facilities. Amazon leases a substantial share of its operational space. Leased facilities are not owned assets that pass by sale - they must be assigned or renegotiated, each subject to its own terms and to landlord consent. The square footage figure measures operational capacity, not acquirable property. Establishing the owned-versus-leased split, and the net book value of the

owned portion, requires Amazon's property records and is a precondition to any credible valuation.

Fleet

Amazon's branded transportation fleet includes approximately 40,000 semi-trucks, 30,000 delivery vans, and approximately 110 aircraft operated through Amazon Air, together with more than 70,000 trailers and more than 20,000 intermodal containers. These are global figures; the United States accounts for the majority but not the whole. Three distinctions bear on acquisition:

1. The 30,000 branded vans are a fraction of the vehicles delivering Amazon packages, because most last-mile delivery is performed by Delivery Service Partners (DSPs) using vehicles those contractors own or lease, which do not transfer with the network
2. The aircraft and a portion of the trailer fleet are leased rather than owned, so here again the figures state operational capacity, with the owned share awaiting financial confirmation.
3. The line-haul trucks and trailers that carry parcels through the network would be acquired, while assets dedicated to the commercial freight service Amazon sells to industrial shippers, including intermodal and rail operations, would remain Amazon's under the perimeter drawn below. The two share vehicles and lanes, so which specific assets would transfer is a question for an audited carve-out.

Automation

More than 1 million robots operate across the fulfillment network, a threshold Amazon reported crossing in 2025, with robotic systems now involved in roughly 75 percent of delivery volume. These systems are developed and produced by Amazon Robotics, the wholly owned subsidiary that began as Kiva Systems, acquired by Amazon in 2012. Amazon Robotics holds the patents, designs, and production capacity behind the deployed fleet. Its intellectual property, more than the unit count, is the consequential asset, because it informs whether the fleet would become dependent on its former owner for replacement and upgrade. The treatment of that intellectual property would be a defined term of the acquisition agreement.

Operational Technology

Routing algorithms, network-planning systems, warehouse-management software, and fleet-coordination tools direct the physical assets above. This layer is the most deeply integrated with Amazon's retail and inventory platforms and the least amenable to clean transfer. Its disposition, by transfer or by license, would also be a defined term of the agreement.

Workforce

The network is operated by more than 1 million workers. The composition of that workforce, the share directly employed against the share contracted, and the obligations attaching to each, are the subject of Chapter 4.

What Public Data Cannot Establish

Three inputs essential to valuation lie outside public reach:

1. The owned-versus-leased division of facilities and fleet
2. The net book value of owned property and equipment
3. The capitalized cost and depreciation schedule of the robotics fleet.

The valuation that follows proceeds on public estimates and states its assumptions.

The Perimeter: What Would Be Acquired, and What Would Not

Amazon today markets its logistics capabilities as a single integrated platform. Amazon Supply Chain Services (ASCS) offers sellers an end-to-end chain: pickup at manufacturing facilities abroad, cross-border ocean and air freight with customs clearance through Amazon Global Logistics (AGL) and Seller Export and Delivery (SEND), bulk storage through Amazon Warehousing and Distribution (AWD), bulk movement to any sales channel through Multi-Channel Distribution (MCD), order fulfillment through Fulfillment by Amazon (FBA) and Multi-Channel Fulfillment (MCF), and parcel carriage to the customer's address, including through Amazon Shipping, the carrier service Amazon sells to outside shippers.

A serious description of an acquisition must state which of these layers would pass to public ownership.

The proposed list of acquisitions follows from the Constitution. Article I, Section 8, Clause 7 gives Congress the power to establish "Post Offices and post Roads," the carrying of items to addresses across the country that the Postal Service exists to perform. The Delivery Network, as this proposal defines it, would be the part of Amazon that now does that same job: the fulfillment centers where orders are picked and packed, the sortation centers and the long-distance trucks and cargo planes that move packages between facilities, the neighborhood delivery stations and the people who carry packages to the door, and the software and robots that run all of it. The government would buy that operation, its buildings, equipment, and workers, but not the goods passing through it, which would still belong to the sellers and shippers who own them. Enabling legislation could apply a simple test: an asset or service would be inside the acquisition if its job is moving goods to American addresses, including the holding of goods that filling an order requires. It would be outside if its job is renting out storage as a service, managing supply chains, or shipping across borders.

Under that test, Amazon would keep its entire supply-chain services business and go on selling it. That includes its storage business (Amazon Warehousing and Distribution), which rents out bulk space for long stretches; its bulk-distribution business (Multi-Channel Distribution), which moves inventory in volume to wholesalers and stores; its international shipping and customs operations (Amazon Global Logistics and Seller Export and Delivery); the Partnered Carrier Program, which is a way of buying trucking rather than a thing to own; Buy with Prime, a checkout button Amazon places on other companies' websites; and the software that coordinates all of these. Every one of them would keep operating, and every one would become a customer of the public network.

What would change is the last step. Goods headed to American customers would be handed to the public network to fulfill and deliver: for Amazon's own packages, under a long-term contract; for every other shipper, at posted rates that are the same for everyone.

The distinction between storage incident to carriage and storage as a product deserves a look, because the two occupy similar buildings. A fulfillment center holds inventory briefly and for one purpose: so that an order placed today can reach an address tomorrow. That holding is part of carriage, as surely as a package resting overnight in a postal processing plant is part of mail

delivery. A bulk storage contract, by contrast, is a warehousing service, a business the Postal Service has never been in and should not enter. The enabling legislation could fix the mission boundary in statute: the network would exist to deliver, and the adjacent businesses of warehousing, supply-chain management, and international freight would remain where they are today, in private hands, as customers of the public network.

Deliver America would acquire what duplicates and supplants the Postal Service, and nothing beyond it.

Valuation Methodology

Figures below are estimates derived from public data, and rest on assumptions stated plainly so a reviewer can test them.

Valuation of the Distribution Network can be approached from multiple angles:

The Asset Approach

The asset approach asks what it would cost to rebuild the network from nothing: over 600 United States facilities and roughly 435 million square feet of operational space, approximately 40,000 trucks and 30,000 branded vans, an air operation of roughly 110 aircraft, more than 1 million deployed robots, the software that coordinates them, and a trained workforce of more than 1 million that no amount of capital could quickly reproduce. This approach yields the highest figure and overstates realizable value, because no buyer pays to rebuild what can be bought.

The Revenue-Multiple Approach

The revenue-multiple approach yields the lowest figure and understates value in the opposite direction. The Delivery Network earns estimated external shipping revenue of \$31.1 billion. This lowballs the value because it prices only what the Delivery Network bills to outside parties and ignores the far larger volume it carries for Amazon's own retail operation at no market charge.

The Going-Concern Approach

The going-concern approach reconciles the two and is the basis this proposal adopts. It values the network on its full throughput priced at market rates, not on the slice of revenue it currently collects externally. Under the long-term service agreement set out later in this chapter, the Delivery Network would bill Amazon retail at regulated market rates for the volume it moves, which today is carried internally and unpriced. Regulation here governs the form of the rate, not its level: a published, non-discriminatory schedule benchmarked to prevailing market prices. The moment that volume is billed, the network's revenue base would expand several fold, and the going-concern value would rise accordingly. This basis prices the network as the operating business it would become under public ownership.

Fair Market Value

On that basis, fair market value falls in a range of approximately \$150 billion to \$250 billion, with a working midpoint near \$200 billion. Publicly available comparable numbers support this range. Because the perimeter excludes warehousing, freight forwarding, cross-border carriage, and commercial freight, the comparison is like-for-like: what would be valued is the same domestic parcel business UPS and FedEx are in, at larger volume. The Delivery Network already moves more parcel volume than UPS, and UPS is worth near \$92 billion. A network larger than the largest incumbent (and growing), should be valued above it, which places a floor over \$92 billion. A midpoint near \$200 billion prices the network at roughly 2.2 times that largest comparable.

The assumption that keeps the figure from running higher: unlike UPS and FedEx (valued near \$78 billion following its spin-off of FedEx Freight on June 1, 2026), this network has never had to cover its own cost of capital as a standalone business, and a disciplined buyer prices the risk that its margins look different once it pays its own way.

Why The US Should Not Acquire Retail or Third-Party Seller Services

The Infrastructure Distinction

The United States distinguishes between the routes commerce travels and the commerce itself. The government builds and owns post roads, and private merchants carry their goods along them; it dredges and maintains rivers, and private freight moves on the water; it finances the

Interstate Highway System, and private trucks and private stores conduct the business made possible. In short: the public provides the right-of-way, which private parties use to buy and sell. No one asks whether a federal highway makes the government a trucking company.

Deliver America would bring the Delivery Network to the public side of that equation. The government would own the network that moves the goods and would have no part in selling them.

Including the marketplace would place the federal government in direct commercial competition with Walmart, Target, every small retailer, and every rival marketplace in the country, setting prices and stocking shelves against private merchants who have no comparable backing. *Deliver America explicitly does not propose this.*

Is This Communism?

No.

The charge that public ownership amounts to Communist capture has little purchase against a government that owns the road and leaves the selling to private interests. Infrastructure in public hands is the ordinary American arrangement: the postal system; the highways; the air traffic control system; the ports, locks and dams, etc. Confined to logistics, the proposed acquisition stays on the side of the line the United States has occupied since its founding.

Legal Encumbrance Questions

Amazon.com, Inc. is the defendant in two active antitrust proceedings concerning the same underlying conduct, one a federal consumer class action and one a state enforcement action, both set for trial in 2027.

The first is *De Coster v. Amazon.com, Inc.* (W.D. Wash.). Filed in 2021 and certified on August 6, 2025, it covers an estimated 288 million consumers, which class counsel call the largest class ever certified in the United States. The claim arises under Section 1 of the Sherman Act.

Plaintiffs allege Amazon charges third-party sellers fees well above competing marketplaces, then bars them from pricing lower elsewhere, so the cost reaches the consumer. The court found common proof that Amazon's policies function as a platform most-favored-nation restraint, barring a seller from undercutting its Amazon price on a competing site. Sellers who price lower

elsewhere can lose the access to Buy Box, have shipping suspended, or face removal. Plaintiffs' economic experts estimated the conduct affected roughly 288 million consumers across 34 billion transactions. The class period runs from May 26, 2017; consumers may opt out until August 31, 2026; trial is set for June 14, 2027, seeking treble damages and injunctive relief.

The second is *California v. Amazon*, filed by Attorney General Rob Bonta in 2022 in San Francisco Superior Court under state antitrust law. On April 20, 2026, Bonta announced the public release of evidence his office called proof of an illegal price-fixing scheme. The unredacted filing describes communications in which Amazon pressed vendors to raise prices on competing retailers, among them Walmart, Target, and Best Buy. A hearing on the state's preliminary injunction is set for July 23, 2026, and trial for January 19, 2027.

Structural Relief

Going forward, the Deliver America acquisition could remove the fulfillment-access lever that gives *California v. Amazon* much of its force. That prospective structural relief, of the kind the government's injunctive actions seek, could retire Amazon's continuing exposure on this conduct regardless of how the existing claims resolve.

The disputed policy works through penalties Amazon imposes on a seller who prices lower on a competing platform. Those penalties draw on two separate powers. The first is *control of fulfillment*: a seller who loses Amazon's fulfillment access loses the means to deliver. The second is *control of demand*: Amazon's marketplace holds the dominant share of online marketplace sales, about 72% by the plaintiffs' estimate, such that removal from the platform severs a seller from where the buyers are.

Public ownership would affect the first power directly. A network owned by the Deliver America Authority and operated at regulated, non-discriminatory rates would serve every shipper on equal terms. A seller who ships through it would no longer depend on Amazon to deliver and would no longer forfeit fulfillment by pricing lower elsewhere. The most coercive of Amazon's levers would be neutralized by the acquisition itself.

The second lever, control of demand, is not directly addressed by Deliver America. Buy Box suppression and deplatforming could persist. Public acquisition of the Delivery Network could

weaken this lever indirectly, however: because fast, reliable Prime delivery is part of what holds shoppers to Amazon, a public network offering comparable delivery to every platform lets competing sites match it, and as they approach parity the cost of losing Amazon falls.

The proposed acquisition removes the fulfillment lever outright and erodes the demand lever over time, achieving prospectively much of what the Federal Trade Commission and California enforcement actions seek. Whether that relief is sufficient, in the sense the antitrust cases use the term, is beyond the scope of this proposal.

The Anchor Customer

If Deliver America is successful, Amazon retail would become the largest customer of a network it no longer owns. Amazon's Distribution Network was built to move Amazon's own goods. If the Distribution Network becomes part of the USPS, Amazon retail's volume is likely to remain its largest source of demand for the foreseeable future. A customer of that scale and steadiness is a foundation to build on.

A long-term service agreement would commit Amazon retail to the USPS Distribution Network through a transition period, perhaps 5-10 years, with a volume commitment agreeable to both parties. Rates would follow a published schedule that declines with volume and applies to every shipper. Amazon would occupy the most favorable tier because of the volume it moves, not because of preference; any shipper at the same volume would receive an identical rate. Amazon, having handed off the capital and operational weight of running its own network, would keep a mature carrier it can rely on without the cost of sustaining it.

4. Workforce Transformation

Documented Current Conditions

The strongest evidence of warehouse conditions is Amazon's own injury data, reported to the Occupational Safety and Health Administration and analyzed by a Senate committee in December 2024. On the company's reported figures, its warehouses recorded injuries more than 30 percent above the warehousing industry average in 2023, ran at nearly twice the industry rate over the preceding 7 years, and exceeded the average at more than two-thirds of facilities.

The pace that produces those injuries is set and enforced by software. Amazon's system logs the interval a warehouse worker spends not scanning items as Time off Task, and by the company's own account the system can generate a warning or a termination from accumulated Time off Task without a supervisor's review. Amazon has separately patented a wristband designed to track a warehouse worker's hand and arm movements and direct them toward inventory bins in real time. Delivery drivers face a comparable structure: many partner-firm drivers are required to run a monitoring application on their phones that records vehicle location, speed, braking, and, in some documented cases, in-cab video, feeding into performance and disciplinary decisions. Four states now require warehouse employers to disclose production quotas and the discipline attached to them.

A workforce paid at these levels is also on record as a workforce the public is already partly supporting. The Government Accountability Office found Amazon among the larger employers of Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program and Medicaid recipients in the states it examined, at a time when fewer than 10 percent of aid recipients nationally worked for a public-sector employer of any kind.

These same roles are marketed heavily to one population in particular. Amazon has built a large, public recruiting apparatus around veterans and military spouses, explicitly framing warehouse and driving work as suited to people trained to make fast decisions under pressure. Amazon's own director of military affairs has stated publicly that a military spouse relocates roughly seven times more often over a career than a civilian spouse, and that many military spouses leave the company when a service member receives relocation orders; the company built an internal retention program, Project Juno, in response.

Clearly, Amazon already understands the advantages of a workforce with publicly funded benefits.

The Delivery Workforce

Most last-mile delivery runs through Delivery Service Partners, independent firms operating across the United States whose drivers are their W-2 employees, not Amazon's - one contractual layer removed from the network they serve.

A separate program, Amazon Flex, engages drivers who use their own vehicles to deliver packages in blocks booked through an app. Amazon classifies these drivers as independent contractors. State authorities have rejected that classification, however. The Virginia Employment Commission found that Amazon had misclassified its Flex drivers, who for unemployment-insurance purposes were employees rather than contractors; the Virginia Court of Appeals upheld that finding in 2023, and the Supreme Court of Virginia left it in place in 2025. The Wisconsin Supreme Court reached the same conclusion under that state's law.

The benefits and protections for these workers depend on which entity employs them and on hours worked. Full-time warehouse staff receive Amazon coverage. Drivers employed through partner firms are covered by those firms, so coverage varies. Flex drivers, classified as contractors, receive no employer coverage at all.

None of these workers hold the standing of federal postal employment: enforceable safety standards, a grievance process, collective bargaining, statutory wage floors, and a path to a career position with full benefits. Extending that standing would be the first consequence of acquisition.

The Overnight Transformation

On the day the acquisition closes, the workforce of the Delivery Network that is directly employed by Amazon would become federal employees under the Deliver America Authority. Operations would continue unchanged, with the same workers reporting to the same facilities and running the same routes the following morning. Operational integration would proceed on the schedule set out in Chapter 7.

Career vs. Non-Career

Federal postal employment is structured in two tiers. Career positions carry the full federal package of benefits. Non-career positions carry a more limited set of benefits and a defined path to career status.

The package attached to a career position includes health coverage, enrollment in the federal retirement system, statutory wage floors, a grievance and arbitration process, and collective bargaining. It also includes a protection particular to postal employment: while most federal

agencies are covered by an internal safety program, The Postal Employees Safety Enhancement Act of 1998 applies the Occupational Safety and Health Act to the USPS in the same manner as to any private employer. Before that Act, the Postal Service was exempt from those private-sector provisions. Workers now covered by OSHA as private employees would lose no safety standing.

The delivery workforce would reach federal employment by a different route than the directly employed. It is composed of two groups: the larger group works for Delivery Service Partners (DSP), the independent firms that run Amazon's delivery routes under contract; those drivers are the firms' employees, not Amazon's. The smaller group is engaged through Amazon Flex and classified as contractors in most states (Virginia and Wisconsin authorities rejected this in favor of employee status.)

It is possible that many current Flex drivers occupy that role specifically for its flexibility and do not seek full time government work. For these, and other individual contractors, it is reasonable to offer non-career positions inside the USPS, analogous to seasonal or non-career positions that already exist.

Precedent

There is a 21st century precedent for rapid conversion of a large contract workforce into federal employment. Congress passed the Aviation and Transportation Security Act on November 19, 2001, setting a one-year deadline for federal officers to take over passenger and baggage screening at every commercial airport in the country. The first airport, Baltimore/Washington International, converted to federal screening on April 30, 2002. All 429 commercial airports had converted by the November 19, 2002 deadline, and the resulting federal screener workforce exceeded 40,000 employees, replacing roughly 16,500 private contract screeners.

A single statute converted the function nationwide. The government did not renegotiate with each of the hundreds of private screening companies operating at individual airports; at each airport, on a set date, the private contract ended and a federal screening force took its place. The relevant precedent is, government can quickly convert a function of this kind, by statute rather than by thousands of separate agreements.

The individual employment guarantee is where enabling legislation for Deliver America might differ by design. TSA terminated the private screeners at each airport when their contract ended, then ran individual screeners through a competitive assessment, background investigation, and citizenship check before they could join the federal workforce. Many did not pass or did not reapply, and the government anticipated meaningful attrition in the process, particularly at larger airports. The Department of Labor provided transition assistance to the screeners the conversion left behind.

Deliver America proposes to borrow the mechanism, a single statute converting the function nationwide on a defined schedule, without the competitive rehiring. How the contracted delivery workforce might convert into the USPS two-tier structure, on a defined timetable, is really a question for the USPS. Ideally, it would happen without reopening each underlying contract, but USPS has its own standards which will attempt to address below.

A Special Case

The roughly 4,400 owners of Delivery Service Partner firms who operate the businesses should probably be approached differently from their employees. Many DSPs are small business owners whose only customer is Amazon.

Enabling legislation could offer each owner a choice. A DPS owner could accept compensation for the terminated contract, covering the unexpired term, vehicles, and other assets, and exit the business. Or, an owner could instead apply for a (station-level?) supervisory role in the new structure, since the dispatch, route assignment, hiring, and compliance work a DSP owner already does will still need doing. The mix of outcomes that would follow, with some owners exiting and others converting into USPS jobs, could resemble what happened to private security firms after TSA federalization: some closed out entirely and others found a continuing role through the Screening Partnership Program.

Deliver America is actively soliciting comment from all Amazon employees, contractors and subcontractors. Please get in touch. Your input is vital to this proposal.

Sidebar: It's worth noting that a meaningful share of Flex drivers are neither US citizens nor permanent residents, which would disqualify them for USPS employment. Expedited

Naturalization in exchange for a period of service, as with the US Armed Forces, would make these roles very desirable for aspiring Americans and incentivise a committed corps of drivers. Deliver America does not explicitly make this recommendation as of this draft, but it's interesting to think about.

The View from Inside USPS

Bringing the Delivery Network's workers into the Postal Service raises two practical questions. How would they get hired, and what would their arrival mean for the postal employees already on the job? The Postal Service's own rules should be a starting point.

Placement of the incumbent workforce

The Postal Service has a standard way of hiring from outside. It posts a job opening, applicants take a test where one is required, qualified applicants are ranked, and a manager selects from the top of that list. This system works well for filling a handful of jobs at a time, but it was never built for the numbers (or novel roles) Deliver America proposes.

So the enabling legislation would take a different route. It would create a one-time permission to move workers inside the acquisition perimeter into postal jobs directly, as the starting staff of the acquired facilities. They would not have to apply for their own jobs or compete against strangers on a ranked list. Moving an entire working team over along with the buildings and equipment they run is a different situation from picking new hires off the street; law would treat it that way.

The usual safety checks would stay. The Postal Service requires a suitability review, a medical assessment, and in some cases a background investigation before someone starts. Under the conversion, those checks would still happen, but they would run as conditions of keeping the job rather than as hurdles to clear before starting. People could begin right away, and anyone who fails a check would be removed rather than blocked at the door.

Veterans' preference

Federal law gives veterans a hiring preference when they apply for postal jobs from outside, under the Veterans' Preference Act of 1944. The conversion would keep that preference in place for every job that opens in the Delivery Network after the initial move. Once the starting

workforce is set, every new opening in the acquired facilities would carry the veterans' preference, exactly as postal jobs do now.

The existing postal workforce

Most frontline postal jobs are filled by seniority. When a position opens, current employees bid on it, and the most senior qualified bidder wins. That bidding right is one of the things postal workers value most, and it's written into their union contracts. A large batch of new jobs could look, at first glance, like it was skipping past those bidding rights. We want to address that concern directly.

Seniority would work on two separate tracks. For bidding, a converted worker's seniority would start on the day of the conversion. A new arrival could never outbid a current employee for an assignment, and every postal worker on the job today would keep their place in line ahead of every convert. For pay, leave, and retirement, a converted worker's years at Amazon could count, so the promise of full benefits on the first day would still hold.

The law would also promise that the acquisition would cost no current USPS worker their job. It would bring no layoffs, no elimination of routes, and no facility closures aimed at the existing workforce. The Postal Service's layoff procedures would not be used against current employees as a result of the conversion.

Converted workers would join existing craft units and be represented like any other postal employee, with union dues handled through the system already in place. Any jobs above entry level in the new facilities, and every future opening in them, would be filled through the normal bidding process under the union contracts. Over time, the acquired network would fold into the same seniority-and-bidding system the rest of the Postal Service already runs on.

All of this would sit inside the postal labor framework set up by the Postal Reorganization Act of 1970, which includes binding arbitration and a no-strike agreement. How automation savings would be shared, and what they would mean for staffing down the road, would be handled by the separate companion paper on the Automation Dividend.

Set up this way, the conversion would bring the Delivery Network's workers into the Postal Service without taking anything away from the workers already there.

Cost Modeling

Federalizing the workforce would change its cost in two ways: the benefits attached to a federal position, and the effect of statutory wage floors on the lowest-paid roles.

Benefits are the larger factor. The Bureau of Labor Statistics puts benefits at about 30 percent of total compensation in private industry and about 38 percent in state and local government, and a federal package sits at the upper end of that range.

That benchmark is a gross figure, and it overstates the added cost for two reasons. Amazon already pays wages and provides benefits to its directly employed workers, and the partner firms already cover many of their drivers, so the cost that matters is the difference between the federal package and the compensation these workers already receive, not the federal package. The two-tier structure governs the increment: a career position carries the full package, a non-career position less. What federalization adds per worker hinges on where the worker enters and on what the worker is paid today.

For that reason the total cannot be fixed from public data. It depends on the current compensation of a workforce whose carve-out financials do not yet exist, on the split between career and non-career tiers, and on the size of the workforce as automation reduces it over the transition.

Appendix B models the total across conservative, base, and optimistic cases rather than resting on a single number. The cost would fall where any carrier's labor cost falls, inside an operating business that bills its throughput at market rates. The question is whether operating revenue covers labor cost, which Appendix C takes up.

An offset runs the other way. Workers placed on federal wage floors and federal benefits draw less on public assistance, a cost other parts of government now carry. The scale of that offset, and the net after it, belong to the fiscal case in Appendix C.

Pension and Retiree Health Obligations: An Honest Accounting

The Postal Service runs two retirement systems. The Civil Service Retirement System (CSRS), a defined-benefit plan closed to anyone hired after 1983, holds the largest legacy obligations. The Federal Employees Retirement System (FERS) covers everyone hired since. The incoming workforce would enter FERS as new hires.

The legacy problem is pretty serious. The Government Accountability Office reported the Postal Service's unfunded CSRS liability at about \$60 billion at the end of fiscal year 2024, and its unfunded FERS liability at about \$46 billion, the latter swollen by payments the agency skipped. The Office of Personnel Management sets the pension amortization payments under federal retirement statutes; the agency controls neither the assumptions nor the schedule, and the payment swings sharply year to year. Other federal agencies receive Treasury or appropriated funds for these obligations; the Postal Service must cover them from operating revenue.

The 2022 Postal Service Reform Act repealed the retiree-health prefunding mandate, canceled the past-due prefunding, and folded postal retiree health into Medicare, so that reform is complete. What still requires companion legislation, with or without this acquisition, is CSRS reallocation.

As automation shrinks the workforce, the base paying in would fall while early-cohort obligations accrue. But FERS funds each benefit as it is earned, and the defined-contribution Thrift Savings Plan holds individual accounts that leave nothing collective behind. The Postal Service's current unfunded FERS liability came from skipped payments, and an operating business billing throughput at market rates could make payments the current USPS cannot.

Recommendations

The legacy CSRS liability, including the disputed allocation, should be flagged as a pre-acquisition matter for the Treasury and the Office of Personnel Management. The incoming workforce should enter FERS as funded by law, with contributions kept current. The reallocation that 2022 left unfinished should be completed, and a share of the Automation Dividend (Chapter 5) could be dedicated to retiree obligations. Deliver America would not solve the legacy pension and retiree-health problem, which predates it and needs its own legislation. What it would do is

add its workforce to the funded system and bring the operating revenue that lets those obligations be met.

5. The Automation Dividend

When a worker's task is automated, the labor cost of that task falls. A facility that needs fewer people to move the same volume of packages costs less to run, and the reduction shows up as margin, moving upward to the owners who automated the job away.

If the Distribution Network moves into public hands, the destination of money saved via automation would become a governance decision, made through the board of the Deliver America Authority, rather than a return calculated for Amazon shareholders. We call that savings the Automation Dividend.

The Automation Dividend could potentially fund five things:

1. Accelerated repayment on the American Commerce Bonds that finance the acquisition
2. A Worker Transition Fund tied to workers whose specific roles are eliminated
3. Rural service expansion under the universal service mission
4. Reduced shipping costs for businesses and households served by the network, and
5. Continued operational improvement at USPS as the two systems integrate.

For purposes of this paper, we estimate the dividend pool at \$20 to 24 billion annually at maturity. This foundations of this estimate, the legislative mechanism that would enact it, and the potential impact of automation on the Delivery Network's workforce are the subject of an upcoming companion paper in Q3 2026, available at DeliverAmerica.org

6. Acquisition Structure

Deliver America proposes a purchase of assets carved out from the corporate entities that hold them today, transferred to public ownership along with the workforce that runs them. Chapter 3 set out what falls inside that perimeter and what it would be worth.

Deliver America does not propose to buy Amazon.com, Inc., a controlling interest in Amazon, or shares in any company. The target is a functional bundle, carved out from Amazon.com, Inc. and its subsidiaries that hold them today.

The acquisition would be negotiated, and it would be priced at fair market value. Chapter 3 estimates that value in a range of roughly 150 to 250 billion dollars on a going-concern basis, with a working midpoint near 200 billion. The proposal does not seek to acquire the network below that value through the pressure of the state. It seeks to pay what the network is worth and to fund the payment as described below.

While the federal government can use eminent domain to acquire private property for public use, (especially for the post office), a negotiated purchase is preferable in every way that matters. A negotiated sale would avoid years of litigation and would keep the network intact and operating through a transition. Further, it would preserve the possibility, developed in the following sections, that the seller has his own reasons to come to the table.

The Transaction Framework

American Commerce Bonds

The negotiated price would be financed, not appropriated. Deliver America proposes to raise the purchase amount through publicly offered infrastructure bonds, sold to institutions and to ordinary citizens, and repaid over time from the revenue the network would generate. We call them American Commerce Bonds.

The country has financed large public undertakings this way before. The Liberty and Victory bonds of the two world wars funded war efforts through direct public subscription, sold in denominations small enough for a household to buy. Municipal revenue bonds build and maintain ports, water systems, and airports across the country every year, serviced by the fees those assets collect rather than by the general tax base. American Commerce Bonds extend that tradition: a public asset, financed by those willing to lend against its revenue, repaid by what it earns.

Bonds would be preferable to direct appropriation for reasons both structural and political. Structurally, they would tie repayment to the asset - there would be no line in the federal budget reading "give the Deliver America Authority billions of dollars." The debt would be serviced by the network's operating revenue on a fixed schedule, insulated from appropriations fights. Politically, an appropriation of this size would be difficult to pass and easy to attack. A bond issue is an investment that pays out on a schedule the asset's earnings can meet, not a tax.

Who purchases the bonds actually matters. A bond holder in the Delivery Network has a stake in the network's success and real ownership of the outcome. War bonds were sold partly for the money and partly to give millions of people a personal share in a national effort. American Commerce Bonds could do the same: build a constituency for the network's success at the moment of its financing, distributed across the individuals and institutions who invest.

The structure itself, the term, the interest rate, the repayment schedule, and the mix of institutional and retail offerings, would be set in the enabling legislation and modeled against the revenue scenarios developed in Appendix C.

The Philanthropic Delta

In Chapter 3, we estimated the fair market value of the Distribution Network near 200 billion dollars on a going-concern basis. If Amazon sells its assets at fair value, every shareholder would receive what the assets are worth at a defensible price.

The price the public pays could be lower than what the network commands in an open sale, however. Such a discount could come from one shareholder, at his own discretion and out of his own holdings. Jeffrey Bezos holds roughly 8.8 percent of Amazon.com, Inc. His proportional interest in a 200 billion dollar sale of these assets would run to something on the order of 15 to 18 billion dollars. Rather than realize that interest Bezos could, if he felt like it, contribute shares of his own, at equivalent value, into the transaction. The public could apply that contribution against the purchase price. Because the shares contributed would be his and no one else's, the reduction would carry no claim on another shareholder's interest and would raise no question of corporate value. Structured as a charitable contribution, it would be a gift in the sense the tax code uses the word. The effect would be to bring the public's financed price toward 183 billion

dollars against assets worth closer to 200 billion. A single contribution of that size would stand among the largest individual charitable acts on record.

What's In It for Amazon?

Every shareholder would be paid in full at fair market value, on the order of \$200 billion on a going-concern basis.

For the company itself, the transaction would convert a capital-intensive division into a large cash payment and a long-term service contract. Amazon Logistics carries the physical plant, the vehicle fleet, the injury rates, and the wage and classification litigation that come with employing more than a million people directly and through contractors. A sale would move all of that off Amazon's books at a fair price, while a long-term anchor customer agreement would preserve the delivery service Amazon's retail business depends on, without Amazon continuing to own, staff, or defend the infrastructure behind it.

The timing also matters. Amazon faces active antitrust litigation with a trial date in 2027. Selling now, on terms Amazon would help negotiate, would put the company in a materially stronger position.

Capital freed by the sale, and management attention no longer spent operating or defending the logistics division, could be redirected to the businesses generating Amazon's actual margin: AWS, advertising, and the AI infrastructure buildout the company has prioritized in every recent earnings call. A logistics network built to move one retailer's parcels is a mature, capital-heavy, comparatively low-margin asset next to those businesses. Selling it at a fair price would be a legitimate capital allocation decision on its own terms.

Sequencing and Transition

The transfer of the directly employed workforce into federal employment would happen at closing, on a single day. The integration of the network with the Postal Service would happen over months.

At closing, ownership of the assets would pass to the public and the workforce would convert to federal employment under the Deliver America Authority as described in Chapter 4. The morning after closing, the same workers would report to the same facilities and run the same routes.

Operational integration would follow on the schedule Chapter 7 develops: selective at first, joining Postal Service and network infrastructure where they complement each other, and fuller over time as the two systems merge. The network would keep running throughout. Nothing about the transfer of ownership would require the network to pause, reorganize, or degrade service while the longer work of integration proceeds.

The word "phase" in this proposal refers to the pace of operational integration, not to a schedule of buying the network in pieces. The Deliver America Authority would take operational control at closing and would hold it permanently. The governance section that follows describes what kind of body it would be.

Governance

The acquired network would become a new department of the United States Postal Service, the way processing, delivery, and retail are now, answering to the Postmaster General. It would not be a separate corporation standing outside the Postal Service, and it would not replace the Postal Service.

The body running the new department would carry the operating weight of the enlarged institution. Its concerns would be concrete ones: how a Postal Service that has absorbed more than a million new workers and taken on service of the American Commerce Bonds would budget and plan against its enlarged revenue, and how the network itself would run from one day to the next. These are management questions, and would be answerable by the people running the network rather than Congress.

Congress would charter the new department, set its mandate, and retain oversight of whether that mandate is met. What the structure would keep at a distance is day-to-day operational control. The department would be built to keep the line between mandate and management clear.

Congress would set the mission and review the results. The Postmaster General and the department would run the network.

The enabling legislation would create the department, authorize the American Commerce Bonds, and convert the workforce to federal employment as a class. A single bill could establish the department, the financing, and the workforce conversion together, rather than leaving any of the three to a later and less certain vote.

Some of what the new department might need is already provided by the USPS. The Postal Service can issue debt to the Treasury at favorable rates, can negotiate volume-based service agreements subject to regulatory review, and from 2022 can offer certain non-postal services to raise revenue.

Who would appoint the leadership of the new department, and through what process? The Postal Service's own Board of Governors, appointed with Senate confirmation and structured to limit any single party's control, offers one starting model.

7. The Transition Plan

This chapter is the most speculative of any in the proposal. What follows here are not firm recommendations. Here we flag what we believe might be reasonable milestones and timelines. Analysis and feedback from industry experts will be necessary to craft a transition plan.

Practical Constraints

Ownership transfer of routing software, warehouse management systems, and fleet dispatch tools that have run continuously for a decade carries real risk. Not every facility in the Distribution Network is owned outright. Some operate under lease, and the acquisition would need to sort out which facilities transfer as owned real estate and which require new lease arrangements or renegotiation with third-party landlords. Internal communications would need to scale to accommodate a new department and its personnel. Further complications and "unknown unknowns" will surely surface. A phased schedule will create a roadmap for USPS to absorb that complexity without degrading service quality.

Principles

Continuity of Service is Paramount. The USPS and Amazon are both nationally recognized brands, and user expectations are high. While the USPS is appreciated for its legacy, Amazon has distinguished itself for its ingenuity. Both are known for their reliability. A central goal of this proposal is to maintain those standards throughout the acquisition process. Delays, errors, and customer confusion are unacceptable.

Think Slowly, Act Quickly. Extended timelines create room for uncertainty and dissipation of resources. Deliver America should be approached with the qualified rigor demanded by major public works projects, national security, and economic stability. By the time Congress acts (hopefully sometime between 2028 and 2030), no part of the transition plan should be TBD.

Plan For Success, and Learn From It. This proposal is an invitation to policy, logistics, and technology experts, in cooperation with the public, to build a plan that is executable the day it is ratified. Advances in transportation, automation, communication, and energy will continue to occur alongside acquisition and integration. The Deliver America Authority should include subject matter experts, including rank and file USPS and Amazon workers, who can model the impact of these gains and update the Transition Plan accordingly.

The phased schedule that follows is built to hold to these three principles.

Day One

On the day the acquisition closes, the Distribution Network would pass permanently into public ownership under the Deliver America Authority.

Federal employment status and the benefits package Chapter 4 describes, health coverage, enrollment in the Federal Employees Retirement System (FERS), statutory wage floors, and Occupational Safety and Health Administration (OSHA) enforcement, would take effect immediately for the directly employed workforce.

The DSP transition mechanism, distinct from direct-employee conversion because DSP owners are small business operators rather than employees, would need to be designed and negotiated with the DSP community prior to day one, following the mechanism the Transportation Security Administration's 2001 to 2002 transition established as precedent.

The routing software would keep directing the same trucks along the same routes it directed the day before.

The First 12 to 18 Months: The Continuity Phase

Existing management would remain in place, with articulated career trajectory plans: some would stay, some would leave, and the Deliver America Authority should track those plans accordingly. This acquired layer of leadership would report to the Postmaster General, or to whomever the Postmaster General deputizes inside the Deliver America Authority. Department leadership, appointed under whatever process the enabling legislation settles on, would need to be in place early enough to oversee the following:

The audited carve-out financials Chapter 3 flags as unavailable from public data, if still incomplete, would be confirmed within this time frame, establishing which facilities and fleet the network owns outright, which operate under lease, and the depreciation schedule of the robotics fleet.

Intellectual property licensing agreements will settle which systems transfer outright and which stay licensed from Amazon. The software layer is less straightforward: routing algorithms, warehouse-management systems, and fleet-coordination tools currently feed the same inventory forecasting, demand planning, and order routing systems Amazon retail uses to run its marketplace, so severing them would mean defining exactly where the Delivery Network's software ends and Amazon's retail and supply chain tools begin, a boundary the licensing agreement would draw. The long-term service agreement with Amazon retail would take effect, locking in the volume commitments and the non-discriminatory rates.

Internal communications systems would need to extend to the USPS's expanded personnel without creating confusion about who reports to whom during the handoff; the requirements for which should be finalized during this period.

Months 18 to 36: The Integration Phase

A unified technology platform would begin development. Tracking, routing, and customer-facing systems that ran as two separate stacks through the Continuity Phase would merge on a schedule set by technical teams doing the work, rather than one fixed by statute.

Physical rebranding, new signage and updated vehicle liveries, would begin in this window too, rolling out gradually as equipment reaches the end of its service life. A wholesale rebrand that pulls working vehicles and functioning facilities out of service to reskin them is not the plan.

Labor relations would mature in parallel. USPS employees work under decades of collective bargaining relationships with the American Postal Workers Union (APWU) and the National Association of Letter Carriers (NALC). By year three, collective bargaining recognition for the newly converted workforce would move from design into practice, with the two legacy workforces operating under one shared framework. These terms would be negotiated with the APWU and NALC.

The anchor customer relationship with Amazon retail would mature in this window as well, alongside the network's opening to other shippers at published, non-discriminatory rates. Third-party volume would grow from the initial group of shippers who join once the network opens toward the broader market.

Rural service expansion should be measurable by this point: delivery speed and reliability in rural service areas would move toward parity with what customers in dense metropolitan areas already receive, using the routing technology and fleet density both networks bring to the merger.

Year 3 and Beyond: Full Consolidation

By year three, the Distribution Network and USPS would operate as a single network under the Deliver America Authority. The two labor forces that operated in parallel through the first three years would combine into one workforce, and the systems that ran alongside each other during the same period would consolidate into one technology platform. Branding would be the last piece to finish changing.

The Automation Dividend could be realizable during this period. As automation reduces the network's headcount needs against its growing volume, a defined share of the resulting savings would begin flowing to bond repayment, the Worker Transition Fund, and the other allocations on the pace automation occurs.

The long-term service agreement with Amazon retail would continue on the term set at acquisition. Amazon retail would likely remain the network's largest customer, paying the same

published rate available to any other shipper of equivalent volume under the non-discrimination provision.

Risk Factors and Mitigation

Not an exhaustive list.

Technology preservation. The Distribution Network's routing algorithms, warehouse management systems, and the institutional knowledge held by the engineers who built and maintain them make up much of what the network is worth acquiring. Retention terms for key technical staff through the Continuity Phase, in addition to well-organized IP licensing, would address this directly: the network would keep access to the people and the systems it needs without a rushed technical handoff.

Culture and operating cadence. Amazon's logistics operation runs on a decision-making speed that federal agencies are not generally built to match, and a mismatch between the two risks slowing the network down. Placing the network inside a self-funding department structured to make independent operating decisions is not sufficient: leadership should draw on subject matter expertise who understand how the network has historically operated.

Political interference. Congressional oversight of a network this size is appropriate. Congressional micromanagement of its daily operating decisions is not. Congress would charter the Deliver America Authority and set its mandate, then review whether that mandate is met; the department itself would run the network day to day.

Labor relations. The incoming workforce and the existing USPS workforce would arrive at this merger from different labor histories. The converting Distribution Network workforce, largely without union representation before conversion, would enter a federal labor relations framework for the first time, while USPS employees would already be operating under established relationships with the APWU and NALC. The risk to manage is timing: running two disconnected labor relations processes longer than necessary would recreate the two-tier structure this merger is meant to eliminate, which is why one shared framework by year three is the target this proposal sets.

Service continuity. A rural customer or an Amazon retail customer should notice nothing about their delivery service changing in year one, and the Amazon retail service agreement's volume commitments would give the network a direct commercial incentive to keep it that way.

Integration work carrying any risk of visible service degradation, a merged tracking system or a consolidated sortation facility, for example, would proceed on the schedule the technical work requires rather than one set by statute.

The anchor customer relationship. Amazon retail would be the network's largest customer and its former owner, a position that would carry more commercial leverage than any other customer. The long-term service agreement would exist to manage that leverage by setting a defined transition term and volume commitments running in both directions, backed by a non-discrimination provision guaranteeing Amazon retail the same rate available to any shipper of equivalent volume. A gradual opening of Amazon retail's volume to competition from other shippers over the agreement's term would keep this relationship from settling into a permanent dependency in either direction.

8. Political Architecture

The Congressional Pathway

Ideally we could make this happen with a single bill chartering the new department, authorizing the American Commerce Bonds, and converting the workforce as a class on the TSA model.

How do we get there?

The postal reform coalition already exists. The Postal Service Reform Act of 2022 passed with substantial bipartisan majorities, assembled by members who worked the issue for years. Those members, their staffs, and the advocacy organizations that supported them constitute a working coalition that has already passed major postal legislation.

The committee map runs through panels holding postal jurisdiction and oversight, Senate Homeland Security and Governmental Affairs and House Oversight chief among them, with

Commerce committees engaged on the carrier and rate questions and Appropriations engaged despite the bond structure, because members of those committees expect to be consulted on anything of this scale whether or not it spends appropriated money. Early staff-level relationships on those committees would matter more than early member endorsements.

One companion measure belongs in or alongside the enabling legislation: the Civil Service Retirement System cost-allocation correction described in Chapters 4 and 8. The Postal Regulatory Commission and the Postal Service Office of Inspector General have both found the current allocation unfair to the Postal Service, at a scale of roughly \$75 billion, and the finding has stood for more than a decade without action. A Congress chartering the new department could settle the old account in the same act.

Natural allies are already seated. Rural-state members of both parties, the labor caucus and Postal advocates in both chambers have spent careers on the institution's survival. None of these members need persuading that the problem exists but might need persuasion with respect to this proposal. Their insights will likely improve it.

By 2028, we hope to build a coalition, place the proposal before the public, and develop legislative text, so that the idea can be taken up by candidates from any party.

Opposition and Responses

"The government can't run anything." The Deliver America Authority is a self-funding department built to keep daily operations apart from the annual political process. It will be run by industry experts, not by Congress. The country has run public enterprises on commercial discipline before; the Tennessee Valley Authority has operated as a self-funding federal corporation for more than 90 years.

"This is socialism." The proposal would purchase assets at fair market value, through negotiation, financed by bonds sold to willing lenders and repaid from revenue. No property would be seized, no industry nationalized by force, and no private commerce displaced.

"It would kill Amazon." Amazon retail, Amazon Web Services, advertising, devices, and every other line of business will be untouched. Amazon would be paid roughly \$200 billion at fair value for assets that consume enormous capital to operate, would shed that operating weight, and would retain guaranteed access to a mature carrier under the long-term service agreement. The company that emerges would be smaller in assets and lighter in capital intensity, with its most profitable divisions intact.

"The price is too high." The price would be financed by bonds repaid from the network's own revenue, tested against a conservative growth scenario, accelerated by the Automation Dividend, and secured against an asset base worth \$150 to 250 billion. The relevant question is not whether \$183 billion is a large number. It is whether the asset's revenue carries the debt.

"It gives government too much power." The proposal would bind the government's hands more tightly than Amazon's are bound today. The network would operate at published, non-discriminatory rates, serving every shipper on equal terms, under a statutory universal-service obligation. The acquisition would replace discretionary private power over the conduit of commerce with regulated public obligation.

FedEx and UPS. Both carriers would have reasons to oppose. However, the status quo is not their friend either: both companies now compete against a vertically integrated rival that controls its own demand. Amazon has already passed both the Postal Service and the private carriers in parcel volume. A Distribution Network in public hands, billing published rates and favoring no marketplace, would be a more predictable competitor than the one they face now. The third-party access provisions would open volume to competitive dynamics rather than close it.

The De Coster litigation. Nothing in this document prejudices an outcome that belongs to the courts. The acquisition would be a purchase of assets that expressly declines to assume marketplace liabilities, leaving the litigation and any resulting exposure with the seller. Though the removal of the fulfillment lever might supply the structural relief plaintiffs seek, the case for Deliver America does not require Amazon to be found liable of anything.

9. Recommendations and Next Steps

The Legislative Vehicle

The goal is a single enabling statute: one bill that would charter the new department within the Postal Service, authorize the American Commerce Bonds, and convert the workforce as a class on the TSA model. That bill should not be the second legislative act, not the first.

The first should be a study act. Congress could direct an independent examination of the acquisition's premises before anyone is asked to vote on the acquisition itself: a commissioned valuation of the Distribution Network on the going-concern basis Chapter 3 sets out, an actuarial review of the workforce conversion Chapter 4 describes, and a financing analysis testing the repayment model in Appendix C against scenarios chosen by impartial analysts. The Government Accountability Office and the Congressional Budget Office exist for exactly this work, and a study act would be a modest ask for members not yet prepared to endorse the transaction.

A study act would also discipline this proposal's own claims. Every figure in this document is offered with its basis shown so that an independent review could confirm, correct, or reject it. We invite review from all interested parties.

The Window to 2028

The remainder of 2026 belongs to public launch and discussion across this document, DeliverAmerica.org, and coalitions we build.

In 2027, the work should turn legislative and analytical. The De Coster and California trials are scheduled for that year, and whatever they decide, the country's attention will be on the structure of Amazon's power over commerce while they run.

By 2028, the proposal should stand as a developed framework with an independent study underway or complete, available to any candidate or platform committee looking for a serious answer on infrastructure, rural service, and automation.

Once More, With Feeling

To the policymakers, staff, analysts, and organizers who have read this far, thank you. We are looking forward to your feedback. We have 3 small asks:

Engage the framework. Test the valuation, the workforce mechanics, the repayment arithmetic. What did we fail to consider?

Commission an independent study. A member of Congress could introduce the study act this year. A committee could request the GAO work without one. A foundation or university could fund an independent version tomorrow.

Begin the negotiation conversation. For people positioned to open a channel to Amazon decision makers, let's talk.

EX MANIBUS POPULI



DELIVER AMERICA

Appendix A: Full Financial Model and Assumptions

Appendix B: Workforce Data and Labor Cost Analysis

Appendix C. The Fiscal Case

The appended models are currently under review for v1.2 update on July 20, 2026. If you'd like a preview, please email deliveramerica@deliveramerica.org.

Compiled Source Citations

Confidence scale:

1 = highest quality (primary source: statute, court opinion, GAO/OIG/PRC report, SEC filing, Amazon's own filing or release, Brookings).

2 = good secondary or a canonical landing page rather than the exact document (major news, industry tracker, agency home page).

3 = lowest quality (single local or regional report, advocacy source, aggregator, or a claim resting on secondary coverage of a primary that is not directly linked).

Where a link is a landing or search page rather than the exact document, it is marked "(landing)"; where a primary is paywalled or not directly located, an accessible secondary link is given and the rating reflects that.

Chapter 1, The Case for Public Acquisition

Amazon Supply Chain Services opened to all businesses (May 4, 2026); AWS-for-logistics framing; launch customers P&G, 3M, Lands' End, American Eagle; freight tier spanning ocean, air, ground, rail.

- Link: <https://www.aboutamazon.com/news/retail/amazon-supply-chain-services-for-business>
- Confidence: 1 (Amazon's own announcement, fetched).

Amazon became the largest US parcel carrier in 2025; the crossover ran ahead of forecast.

- Link: Pitney Bowes Parcel Shipping Index (landing) <https://www.pitneybowes.com/us/shipping-index.html>
- Confidence: 2 (the specific 2025 volume/revenue figures are not yet tied to a located primary).

USPS financial crisis figures (losses, cumulative, delivery points). Owned by Appendix C; see there.

Delivery Network volume growth of 688 percent, 2018 to 2024.

- Link: Capital One <https://capitaloneshopping.com/research/package-delivery-statistics/>
- Link: MWPVL or Amazon volume data (landing) <https://www.mwpvl.com>
- Confidence: 2

De Coster class of ~288 million consumers. Owned by Chapter 3; see there.

Chapter 2, Constitutional and Historical Foundation

Postal Clause and Necessary and Proper Clause (Article I, Section 8, Clauses 7 and 18).

- Link: <https://constitution.congress.gov/constitution/article-1/>
- Confidence: 1 (constitutional text).

Federal eminent domain for public use. Kohl v. United States, 91 U.S. 367 (1875).

- Link: <https://supreme.justia.com/cases/federal/us/91/367/>
- Confidence: 1 (Supreme Court opinion).

Federal-Aid Highway Act of 1956 (41,000 miles; \$25 billion authorization).

- Link: <https://www.fhwa.dot.gov/interstate/history.cfm> (Federal Highway Administration history)
- Confidence: 2 (agency history page).

Tennessee Valley Authority Act (signed May 18, 1933); self-funding federal corporation.

- Link: <https://www.tva.com/about-tva/our-history>
- Confidence: 2 (agency history page).

Aviation and Transportation Security Act (November 19, 2001); TSA federalization; ~16,500 private to 40,000-plus federal screeners.

- Link (statute): <https://www.govinfo.gov/app/details/PLAW-107publ71>
- Confidence: 1 for the statute; the screener figures are 2 and should be confirmed against GAO/DHS records

Rural Electrification Act (signed May 20, 1936); ~90 percent of farms without power.

- Link: <https://www.govinfo.gov/app/details/COMPS-1866> (Rural Electrification Act, compiled statute)
- Confidence: 2 (confirm the 90 percent figure against USDA/REA history).

Andrew Carnegie: sold Carnegie Steel to J.P. Morgan; \$60 million; ~1,600 public libraries; 1892 Homestead Strike.

- Link: <https://www.carnegie.org/interactives/foundation-history/> (Carnegie Corporation history)
- Confidence: 2

Chapter 3, Proposed Acquisitions (perimeter, valuation, litigation)

ASCS component map (AGL, SEND, AWD, MCD, PCP, FBA, MCF, Amazon Shipping) in Amazon's own names.

- Link: <https://www.aboutamazon.com/news/small-business/supply-chain-by-amazon>
(Supply Chain by Amazon, September 12, 2023)
- Confidence: 1 (Amazon's own release).

ASCS seller services page.

- Link: <https://sell.amazon.com/supply-chain>
- Confidence: 2 (product page, subject to update).

ASCS opened to all businesses; freight tier including rail.

- Link:
<https://www.aboutamazon.com/news/retail/amazon-supply-chain-services-for-business>
- Confidence: 1.

Comparable valuations: UPS near \$92 billion; FedEx near \$78 billion (post FedEx Freight spin-off, June 1, 2026).

- Link: market data (landing); UPS and FedEx investor relations <https://investors.ups.com>
and <https://investors.fedex.com>
- Confidence: 2 (confirm current market caps; operating margins should be pulled from annual reports).

External shipping revenue \$31.1 billion (2024), 12.2 percent YoY, 25.8 percent CAGR.

Cross-reference Appendix A. Amazon 10-K underlies the fulfillment/shipping spend.

- Link: <https://www.sec.gov/cgi-bin/browse-edgar?action=getcompany&CIK=0001018724&type=10-K> (Amazon 10-K, EDGAR)
- Confidence: 2 (the \$31.1 billion external figure is an estimate pending a composition check; the 10-K spend line is 1).

Facility and fleet inventory (600-plus US facilities, ~435 million sq ft, ~40,000 trucks, ~30,000 vans, ~110 aircraft).MWPVL International.

- Link: https://www.mwpvl.com/html/amazon_com.html (MWPVL Amazon network page)
- Confidence: 2 (re-pull by facility type on the perimeter).

De Coster v. Amazon.com, Inc. (W.D. Wash.); ~288 million class; certified August 6, 2025; trial June 14, 2027.

- Link: <https://www.courtlistener.com/?q=De+Coster+v.+Amazon> (docket search)
- Confidence: 2 (confirm the certification order and trial date from the docket).

California v. Amazon (AG Bonta, 2022; unredacted filing April 20, 2026; trial January 19, 2027).

- Link: <https://oag.ca.gov/news> (California Attorney General newsroom, landing)
- Confidence: 2 (confirm the filings and dates).

Chapter 4, Workforce Transformation

Amazon warehouse injuries above the warehousing-industry average (2017 to 2023), from Amazon's own OSHA data. Senate HELP Committee majority staff report, December 2024.

- Link: <https://www.help.senate.gov> (committee site, landing)
- Confidence: 2 (weight rests on the underlying OSHA Injury Tracking Application data, which is Amazon's own; locate the exact report to confirm).

Time off Task (automated discipline from productivity logs).

- Link: Vice/Motherboard 2020 coverage (landing) <https://www.vice.com/en/section/tech>
- Confidence: 3 (locate the specific article; the durable claim rests on Amazon's own account).

State warehouse quota-disclosure laws (California, New York, Washington, Minnesota).

- Link: California Warehouse Quota law (AB 701) https://leginfo.legislature.ca.gov/faces/billTextClient.xhtml?bill_id=202120220AB701
- Confidence: 2 (California confirmed; New York, Washington, and Minnesota statutes should be pulled to confirm).

Delivery Service Partners; drivers are W-2 employees of partner firms.

- Link: <https://www.aboutamazon.com/news/transportation/amazon-delivery-service-partner-dsp-rate-increases-investment> (Amazon DSP program, September 2024)
- Confidence: 1 (Amazon's own program page). US-only driver count is a data gap; the paper uses ~275,000 (see Appendix B).

Amazon Flex misclassification. Amazon Logistics, Inc. v. Virginia Employment Commission, 78 Va. App. 521 (2023), aff'd (Va. 2025, on procedural grounds); Wisconsin Supreme Court (via NELP, August 2025).

- Links: <https://law.justia.com/cases/virginia/court-of-appeals/2023/> (Virginia Court of Appeals, locate 78 Va. App. 521); <https://www.nelp.org> (Wisconsin holding, landing)
- Confidence: 2 (locate the exact Virginia opinion and the Wisconsin case name/citation). Note: the defendant "Amazon Logistics, Inc." is a distinct entity from the intended acquired asset (the Delivery Network).

Coverage by employing entity; DSP health coverage at or above ACA standards.

- Link: <https://www.aboutamazon.com/news/transportation/amazon-delivery-service-partner-dsp-rate-increases-investment>
- Confidence: 1.

TSA scale comparison; two-tier career/non-career postal employment. TSA cross-references Chapter 2. Two-tier: NALC and APWU national agreements.

- Links: <https://www.nalc.org/workplace-issues/contract-administration> and <https://apwu.org/collective-bargaining>
- Confidence: 2

OSHA enforcement over the Postal Service. Postal Employees Safety Enhancement Act of 1998 (Pub. L. 105-241).

- Link: <https://www.govinfo.gov/app/details/PLAW-105publ241>
 - Confidence: 1. Supporting: USPS OIG report HR-AR-12-001 (landing) <https://www.uspsoig.gov>.
-

Chapter 5, The Automation Dividend

More than 1 million robots (mid-2025); ~75 percent of delivery volume touches a robotic system.

- Link: <https://www.aboutamazon.com/news/operations> (Amazon operations/robotics, landing)
- Confidence: 2

Chapter 6, The Acquisition Structure

Bezos holds ~8.8 percent of Amazon.com, Inc.; interest in a ~\$200 billion sale runs to \$15 to 18 billion. Amazon 2026 proxy (DEF 14A).

- Link: <https://www.sec.gov/cgi-bin/browse-edgar?action=getcompany&CIK=0001018724&type=DEF+14A>(EDGAR)
- Confidence: 1 for the proxy (pull the exact share count and date; the \$15 to 18 billion is the paper's bounded arithmetic).

A \$15 to 18 billion contribution among the largest individual charitable acts on record.

Bounded comparison.

- Link: none required unless hardened; reference points (largest lifetime giver; largest single gift) TO CONFIRM
- Confidence: 2 (kept bounded deliberately).

Six-day delivery requirement. 39 U.S.C. § 101(b), as amended by PSRA 2022.

- Links: <https://www.law.cornell.edu/uscode/text/39/101> and <https://www.govinfo.gov/app/details/PLAW-117publ108>
- Confidence: 1. Accuracy note: before 2022 this was an annual appropriations rider, not standing statute (GAO B-324481, 2013).

USPS self-funding framework; Treasury borrowing; Negotiated Service Agreements; post-2022 non-postal-services authority. USPS OIG, "Business or Public Service?"

- Link: <https://www.uspsoig.gov> (landing; locate the specific report)
- Confidence: 2 (NSA authority under PAEA 2006, <https://www.govinfo.gov/app/details/PLAW-109publ435>, confidence 1).

Universal-service obligation (every address; no small post office closed solely for a deficit).

39 U.S.C. § 101(b).

- Link: <https://www.law.cornell.edu/uscode/text/39/101>
- Confidence: 1.

Bond-financing precedents (Liberty and Victory bonds; Highway Trust Fund; municipal revenue bonds). Illustrative.

- Link: <https://www.treasurydirect.gov/history/> (Treasury history, landing)
 - Confidence: 2 (light sourcing adequate; the self-financing conclusion rests on the Chapter 3 revenue base).
-

Chapter 7, The Transition Plan

Synthesis chapter; most content cross-references Chapters 3, 4, 5, and 6.

Warehouse workforce employed principally by Amazon.com Services LLC.

- Link: <https://www.sec.gov/cgi-bin/browse-edgar?action=getcompany&CIK=0001018724&type=10-K> (Amazon corporate structure via filings, landing)
- Confidence: 2 (confirm against filings or state employment registrations).

APWU and NALC collective bargaining relationships.

- Links: <https://apwu.org> and <https://www.nalc.org>
- Confidence: 2 (cross-reference Chapter 4 for the specific agreements).

TSA 2001 to 2002 class-conversion precedent. Cross-reference Chapter 2 (ATSA).

Chapter 8, The Political Architecture

PSRA 2022 passed with substantial bipartisan majorities. PSRA 2022.

- Link: <https://www.congress.gov/bill/117th-congress/house-bill/3076> (Congress.gov; roll-call votes are linked from the "Actions" tab)
- Confidence: 1 (statute/roll calls; if ever hardened to counts, reported as Senate 79 to 19 and House 342 to 92, TO CONFIRM from the roll calls).

CSRS reallocation ~\$75 billion, unaddressed for a decade. Cross-reference Chapter 8.

TVA self-funding for 90-plus years. Cross-reference Chapter 2.

De Coster and California v. Amazon; ~72 percent marketplace share (plaintiffs' estimate).
Cross-reference Chapter 3.

Amazon Supply Chain Services opening access. Cross-reference Chapters 1 and 3.

FedEx and UPS as opponents. Characterization; no citation. If lobbying figures are added,
source to <https://www.opensecrets.org>.

Chapter 9, Recommendations and Next Steps

GAO, CBO, and PRC as the bodies for a study, valuation, and diligence phase.

- Links: <https://www.gao.gov>, <https://www.cbo.gov>, <https://www.prc.gov>
- Confidence: 1 (referenced by role; no empirical claim).

Amazon has reduced its postal business by 20 percent.

- Link: <https://www.newsnationnow.com/business/amazon-packages-sent-usps/>
- Confidence: 2

De Coster and California trials scheduled 2027; parcel-volume crossover 2025.

Cross-reference Chapters 3 and 1.

Appendix A, Full Financial Model and Assumptions

Not comprehensive.

Fulfillment and shipping spend \$194.3 billion. Amazon 10-K.

- Link: <https://www.sec.gov/cgi-bin/browse-edgar?action=getcompany&CIK=0001018724&type=10-K>
- Confidence: 1 (confirm the exact line and year).

External revenue \$31.1 billion; 12.2 percent; 25.8 percent CAGR. Cross-reference Chapter 3.

UPS ~\$92 billion; FedEx ~\$78 billion; operating margins. Cross-reference Chapter 3.

- Links: <https://investors.ups.com> and <https://investors.fedex.com>
- Confidence: 2 (pull operating margins from the annual reports).

Bezos 8.8 percent stake. Cross-reference Chapter 6 (EDGAR proxy). Confidence 1.

Facility inventory (MWPVL). Cross-reference Chapter 3. Re-pull by type to confirm.

Appendix B, Workforce Data and Labor Cost Analysis

Not comprehensive.

Benefits ~30 percent of compensation (private), ~38 percent (state and local). Bureau of Labor Statistics, Employer Costs for Employee Compensation.

- Link: <https://www.bls.gov/ect/> (BLS ECEC)
- Confidence: 1 (cite the specific ECEC release for the file).

Amazon among the larger employers of SNAP and Medicaid recipients; fewer than 10 percent of aid recipients work in the public sector. GAO-21-45 (and follow-up GAO-21-410T).

- Links: <https://www.gao.gov/products/gao-21-45> and <https://www.gao.gov/products/gao-21-410t>
- Confidence: 1.

Turnover ~150 percent; ~\$8 billion turnover cost. NYT 2021; Engadget October 2022.

- Links: <https://www.nytimes.com> (NYT, TO CONFIRM direct URL) and <https://www.engadget.com/amazon-attribution-leadership-ctsmd-201800110-201800100.html>
- Confidence: 1 (Engadget direct); 2 (NYT direct URL pending).

Loaded compensation ~\$29 an hour. WHYY, May 2025.

- Link: <https://whyy.org> (landing)
- Confidence: 3 (single regional report; confirm as network-wide).

DSP driver population (~275,000 US, partner-firm W-2 employees). US-scoped estimate consistent with Amazon's global 390,000 DSP driving jobs.

- Link: <https://www.aboutamazon.com/news/transportation/amazon-delivery-service-partner-dsp-rate-increases-investment>
 - Confidence: 2 (confirm against a US-specific breakout).
-

Appendix C, The Fiscal Case

Not comprehensive.

USPS net loss \$9.0 billion (FY2025), \$9.5 billion (FY2024), \$6.5 billion (FY2023); ~\$109 billion cumulative since 2007; on the GAO High Risk List since 2009.

- Links: <https://about.usps.com/newsroom/financials/> (USPS financial results, landing) and <https://www.gao.gov/high-risk-list>
- Confidence: 2 for the USPS figures (anchor each to the audited annual reports/Form 10-K); 1 for the High Risk List.

PAEA 2006 prefunding (~\$5.5 billion a year); PSRA 2022 repeal and Medicare integration.

- Links: <https://www.govinfo.gov/app/details/PLAW-109publ435> (PAEA) and <https://www.govinfo.gov/app/details/PLAW-117publ108> (PSRA)

- Confidence: 1 (statutes).

168 million delivery points, six days a week.

- Link: <https://about.usps.com/who/profile/> (USPS profile, landing)
- Confidence: 2 (confirm the current delivery-point count).

Retiree/pension charges are OPM-determined, outside USPS control, near \$10 billion a year, and account for most of the gap between the reported loss and near break-even.

Brookings, Elena Patel, March 2026.

- Link: <https://www.brookings.edu/articles/the-us-postal-services-fiscal-crisis/>
- Confidence: 1 (fetched; draws on USPS financials, OPM, GAO, OIG).

CSRS cost-allocation correction worth ~\$75 billion in USPS's favor. PRC and USPS OIG findings.

- Links: <https://www.prc.gov> (landing) and <https://www.uspsoig.gov> (landing)
- Confidence: 2 (locate the specific PRC and OIG reports and the \$75 billion estimate).

Workers at large employers on federal assistance while employed. GAO-21-45.

- Link: <https://www.gao.gov/products/gao-21-45>
- Confidence: 1. See Appendix B.

Scale comparisons: ~\$850 billion annual defense appropriation; Interstate Highway System cost.

- Links: <https://www.cbo.gov/topics/defense-and-national-security> (CBO, landing) and <https://www.fhwa.dot.gov/interstate/history.cfm>
- Confidence: 2 (hedged in prose; anchor to the appropriations act/CBO and FHWA, TO CONFIRM).

AI Disclosure

In the creation of this document, I have used Claude (Sonnet 4.6, Sonnet 5.0, Opus 4.8 and Fable 5.0) as a research analyst and editor. While I am an informed voter and citizen, I have not previously made policy recommendations beyond the County level. I used Claude to:

- Identify and validate relevant, timely sources of data.
- Structure a document appropriate for public consideration of policy adoption at the federal level.
- Draft financial models suitable for review by experts.
- Identify my blind spots, assumptions and biases.
- Moderate my tone (which tends to snark) and help me adhere to measured, nonpartisan professional language.
- Act as a thesaurus and/or dictionary when uncertain about the right word to select.

The proposal's arguments and conclusions are my own. Errors are my own.

Throughout the process, Claude has shared insights from financial data, American history and current events. While not all insights were salient (or accurate), in some surprising instances they updated my understanding of the problem space and impacted the scope and content of this document. Claude is a promising intern with a bright future ahead of them!

Every citation has been (or is in the process of being) reviewed for accuracy by a human. Every released version was proofread and approved by me (and other humans).

Comments and corrections are welcomed at DeliverAmerica2028@gmail.com

Katharine Lee Nelson
Portland, OR
July, 2026